The model binder will convert pretty much any primitive .NET type such as `int`, `float`, `decimal` (and `string` obviously), any custom type that has a `TryParse` method (like minimal APIs, as you saw in chapter 7) plus anything that has a `TypeConverter`.

NOTE `TypeConverter`s can be found in the System.ComponentModel.TypeConverter package. You can read more about them in Microsoft's "Type conversion in .NET" documentation: http://mng.bz/A0GK.

There are a few other special cases that can be converted from a string, such as `Type`, but thinking of it as built-in types only will get you a long way there!

16.2.2 Binding complex types

If it seems like only being able to bind simple built-in types is a bit limiting, you're right! Luckily, that's not the case for the model binder. Although it can only convert `string`s directly to those simple types, it's also able to bind complex types by traversing any properties your binding models expose, binding each of those properties to `string`s instead.

If this doesn't make you happy straight off the bat, let's look at how you'd have to build your page handlers if simple types were your only option. Imagine a user of your currency converter application has reached a checkout page and is going to exchange some currency. Great! All you need now is to collect their name, email address, and phone number. Unfortunately, your page handler method would have to look something like this:

```
public IActionResult OnPost(
  string firstName, string lastName,
  string phoneNumber, string email)
```